

1. I found an old interview mine (2017)

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Mon, 07 Sep 2026 23:20:02 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/byte-size/interviewing-with-thatsoftware-dude>

I was debugging an issue and I found a link to my blog! Interviewing a senior software engineer Biggest challenge so far in any coding project? My biggest challenge isn't code per se. It is explaining to someone else what I am trying to do with the code. It is surprisingly hard to convert the thoughts in my head (or the code) into something coherent someone else can understand. I still believe that. I don't even remember when we had this discussion, but I'm glad Walter has kept it up. And a great reminder of my priorities. If you weren't coding, what would you be doing? I'd be a writer. (not a good one, but one nonetheless) Yep.

2. Clickable whitespace

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Mon, 07 Sep 2026 21:53:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/clickable-whitespace>

It's easier for someone in my position, after working 20 years in this field to talk about morals. I can disagree with the choices my employer makes. In fact, I can walk away. But I remember the dilemma I felt I was in, earlier in my career. The lead developer stood behind me while I was working on a feature and asked me to make a div clickable. That's it. Technically, it's the simplest thing you can do. But, I hesitated. He watched from behind as I tabbed through every application on my computer, doing everything but what he asked. "Just make it clickable," he said again. I have made divs clickable a thousand times in my then short career, I knew that html standards were merely a suggestion. But this one rubbed me the wrong way. Instead I said, "I already have an anchor tag below, the div doesn't need to be clickable." "The fuck you're talking about? Just do it." We got into an argument, and I ended up doing exactly what he said. A little after I pushed my code, he revisited my code and added a slight delay to my click event using setTimeout to disconnect the user action to what occurred after. If what I'm saying sounds a bit vague, that's how it was framed at a time. We had disc...

3. llm 0.35

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-07T23:54:54+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/7/llm/>

Release: llm 0.35 New OpenAI model: gpt-6-astra for GPT-6 Astra . Tags: openai , llm , gpt-6-astra

4. Creepy crawlies

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-07T23:08:58+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/7/creepy-crawlies/>

Creepy crawlies Konstantin Ryabitsev discusses how bad the "background radiation" of abusive crawlers has become from the perspective of git.kernel.org , the official Git repository for the Linux kernel: TL;DR: we spend more CPU cycles rendering commits for scrapers than we spend on all other kinds of legitimate access, including git clones. At any one time, across 5 geo-distributed nodes, there are 14 CPU cores doing nothing but rendering git commits as html. I worry about this a lot from the perspective of Datasette, which serves a huge number of crawlable web pages. Via Hacker News Tags: crawling , git , linux , datasette , ai-ethics

5. Quoting Jakub Pachocki

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-07T22:26:25+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/7/jakub-pachocki/>

The strongest argument I see for continuing to train much smarter models quickly is the need to build defensive systems against the dangers posed by other AI. [...] We will need powerful,

aligned AI for defense; to secure infrastructure, to protect against rogue agents in real time, and to invent entirely new protective measures. This will be a primary focus of OpenAI's deployment efforts. At the same time, even with the uncertainty that comes from anticipated broad AI progress and the need to build defensive systems, we must not let that become an excuse for recklessness. The idea of racing forward at all costs seems absurd once one internalizes the seriousness of the stakes. ? Jakub Pachocki , Chief Scientist at OpenAI Tags: ai-ethics , openai , ai

6. Automatically detecting AI text in my browser

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/deckard/>

Automated AI text detection is currently an underserved niche. The only game in town is Pangram , which does an excellent job but desperately needs more competition. In a few years, I would be surprised if every major social network doesn't scan new posts and comments for AI content in order to tag them (or simply remove them). I like that I can rely on Pangram to confirm my suspicions when I read something that sounds like AI. But it'd be much better if I could choose to avoid AI-generated text in the first place. What I want is something that runs in the background and automatically scans text on websites I visit, without me having to ask for it. I could build something like this on top of Pangram, but it'd cost money , and in general I don't like the idea of sending every piece of text my browser sees to a third-party service. What about local models? The open-source models available for AI text detection are fine . Pangram claims a 99.66% detection rate with a 0.004% false positive rate. I benchmarked a bunch of small local models against a combination of AI-detection datasets and got these results: Model / variant Human falsely flagged AI-involved text caught Gradient ? M...

7. [Sponsor] Glyphs 4

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-07T22:16:26Z

Link: <https://glyphsapp.com/>

Glyphs 4 is here: a Mac-native app for creating fonts, lettering, icons, and pictograms. Draw with flexible strokes and efficiently reuse shapes across huge glyph sets, explore variable vector designs with complex higher-order interpolation. Build and manage massive font families and icon sets with ease, export all modern font formats, SVG, PNG and PDF. Hundreds of refinements and native Tahoe support make designing, testing and shipping your vectors smoother than ever. Glyphs 4: Create. Love the process. Discover Glyphs 4 , and use code FIREBALL to save \$30 if you purchase in the next month. ?

8. Trackables 1.5

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-07T22:01:27Z

Link: <https://trackables.app/>

Trackables: There are plenty of health tracking apps. Surprisingly, nearly all of them are bloated, subscription-gated, or blatantly harvesting our data; often all three. We wanted something simpler, less annoying and more fun, that's where it started. Trackables turns the data your Apple Watch already collects ? activity, sleep, steps, heart rate ? into a clear, friendly, transparent interface. Totally free of charge, totally private, made by a small team of ex-Apple folks. (They might add a paid tier in the future, but core functionality will remain free.) I've been using Trackables for months and it's just a better dashboard to the stats I care about than the Health app itself. (One interesting detail: HealthKit only makes raw data available to apps. Apple Health's ?sleep score? isn't part of that data ? only the raw input, like how many hours you slept, and how much time was spent in each sleep stage. So Trackables computes its own sleep score. When I bother to compare, Trackable's score is almost always similar to Apple's, but seldom exactly the same. But I personally find that Trackable's sleep score corresponds better to how I feel I slept. Which, admittedly, is usually pre...

9. The Onion's Exclusive Interview With Larry Ellison

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-07T20:09:27Z

Link: <https://theonion.com/the-onions-exclusive-interview-with-larry-ellison/>

The Onion: The Onion: How did you get into the entertainment industry? Ellison: I remember going to the movies as a kid, and when the houselights went down and that hush fell over the crowd, I'd think to myself: I'd like to build a massive propaganda apparatus one day. ?

10. Ngram error rate

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 07 Sep 2026 18:35:45 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/07/ngram-error-rate/>

The Online Etymological Dictionary gives the following etymology for grok: grok (v.) ?understand empathically,? 1961, an arbitrary formation by U.S. science fiction writer Robert A. Heinlein (1907-1988) in his book ?Stranger in a Strange Land.? In the book it is a transliteration of a Martian word and is said to mean etymologically ?to drink.? It attained [?] The post Ngram error rate first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. The Education of a Doomer

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 00:00:00 +1000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/the-education-of-a-doomer>

How and why I went from AI optimist to AI doomer.

12. Kunsten '92 praatje: De AI Trein

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 06 Sep 2026 13:37:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/kunsten92-paradiso-2026/>

Zondag 6 september mocht ik voor het Paradiisodebat van Kunsten '92 de aftrap geven voor twee uur discussie over AI. Er is een uitstekende video-opname van het hele evenement (link naar mijn bijdrage). Ik ben de organisatie erg dankbaar voor de uitnodiging voor dit publiek te spreken. Voor mij als nerd uit de tech scene was dit een heel fijn uitstapje, eens ?gluren bij de burens?. Want daar word je altijd wijzer van.